ACADEMIC EXPERIMENT REPORT

ZOHO CREATOR — PLATFORM EXPLORATION

Setting up a Zoho Creator Account and Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

A practical study of Zoho Creator's low-code environment, its layered architecture, and the core modules of its interface.

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Setting up a Zoho Creator Account and Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

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Introduction

This report presents a practical exploration of setting up a Zoho Creator account and understanding its platform architecture and user interface. Zoho Creator is a **low-code application development platform** that enables users to build business applications using drag-and-drop components such as Forms, Reports, and Pages, while also supporting Deluge scripting for advanced business logic and automation.

The experiment demonstrates how different components of Zoho Creator work together to simplify application development. Throughout this exercise, the platform's layered architecture—including data collection, presentation, automation, and security—is explored using different modules available within the Creator interface.

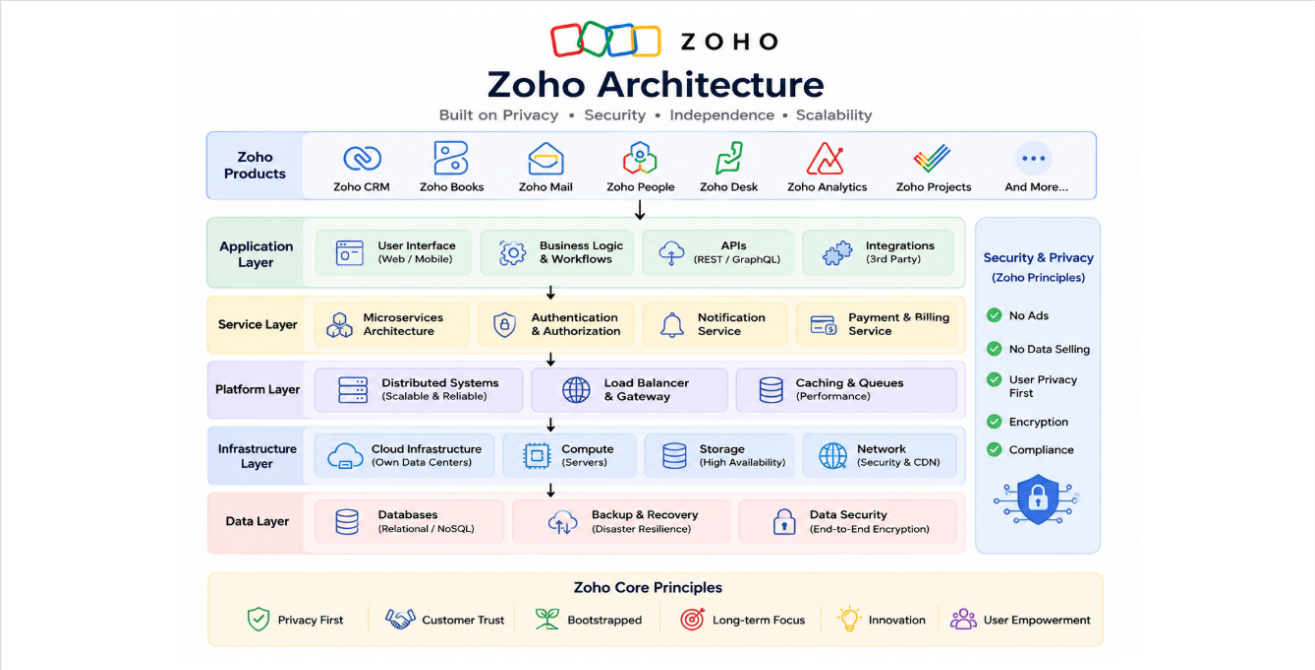
Zoho Creator Platform Architecture

Before exploring the interface, it is important to understand the architecture of Zoho Creator. The platform follows a **layered architecture** that supports the complete lifecycle of application development—from user access to deployment and maintenance.

The major architectural layers include:

- **Access Layer:** Provides multiple ways to access applications, including web browsers, mobile applications, portals, and APIs.
- **Presentation Layer:** Consists of Forms, Reports, and Pages that allow users to interact with the application.
- **Application & Logic Layer:** Includes Workflows, Deluge scripting, integrations, and automation services responsible for business logic.
- **Data Layer:** Stores application data securely using cloud databases, file storage, and backup services.
- **Governance & Security:** Manages user roles, permissions, authentication, and organizational policies.
- **Deployment & Lifecycle:** Supports staging, production deployment, version management, and application publishing.
- **Monitoring & Administration:** Provides analytics, operational monitoring, billing, and overall system administration.

This layered architecture enables developers to build scalable, secure, and maintainable business applications while reducing development effort.



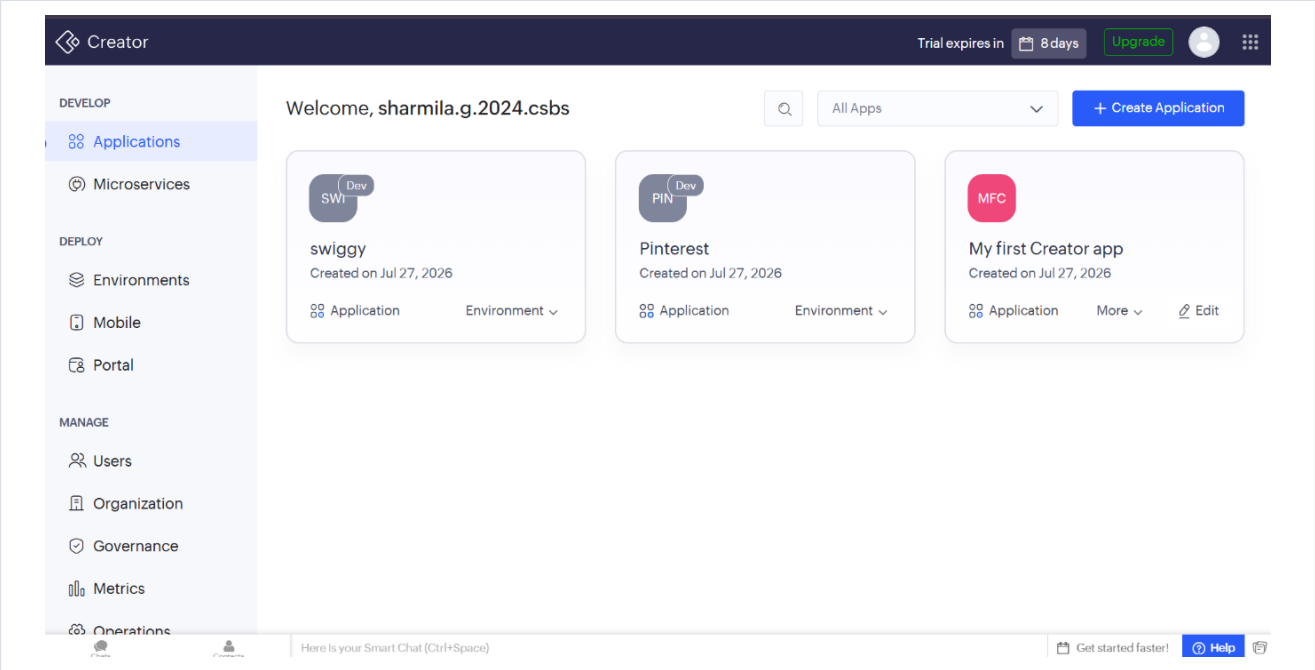
Zoho Creator platform architecture overview

Platform Modules

ZOHO CREATOR INTERFACE

01 Applications

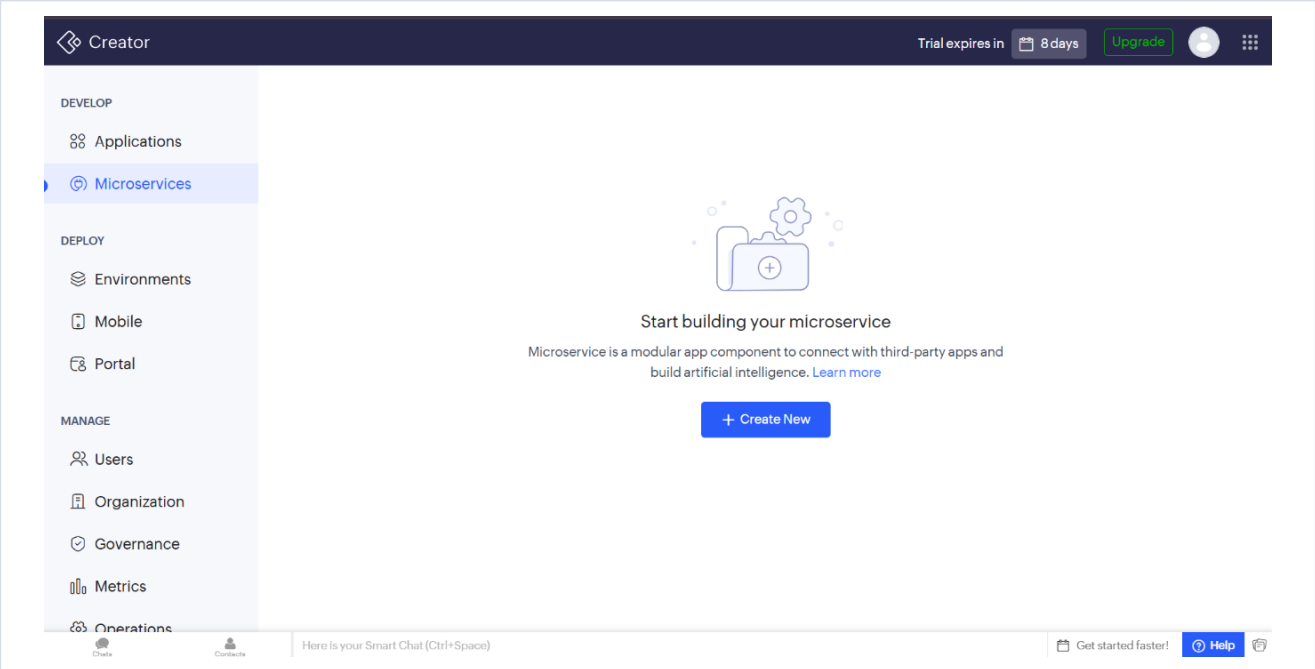
The **Applications** module is the central workspace in Zoho Creator where users can create, manage, and maintain business applications. It provides access to all application components, including forms, reports, pages, workflows, and settings. Developers can build applications from scratch, use ready-made templates, or import existing data. This module serves as the foundation for developing customized low-code solutions that meet business requirements.



Applications module interface

02 Microservices

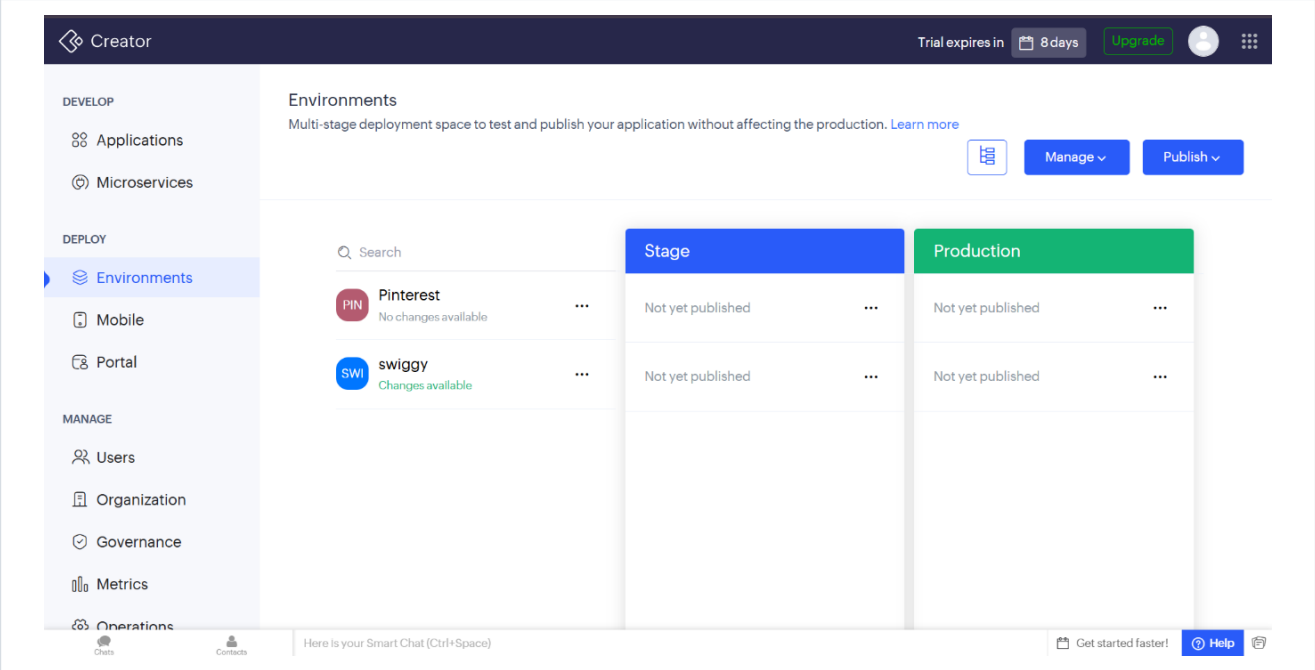
The **Microservices** module enables developers to create and manage independent backend services that perform specific business operations. These services can be reused across multiple applications and integrated with external systems using APIs. By separating business logic into smaller services, the module improves application scalability, flexibility, and maintainability.



Microservices module interface

03 Environments

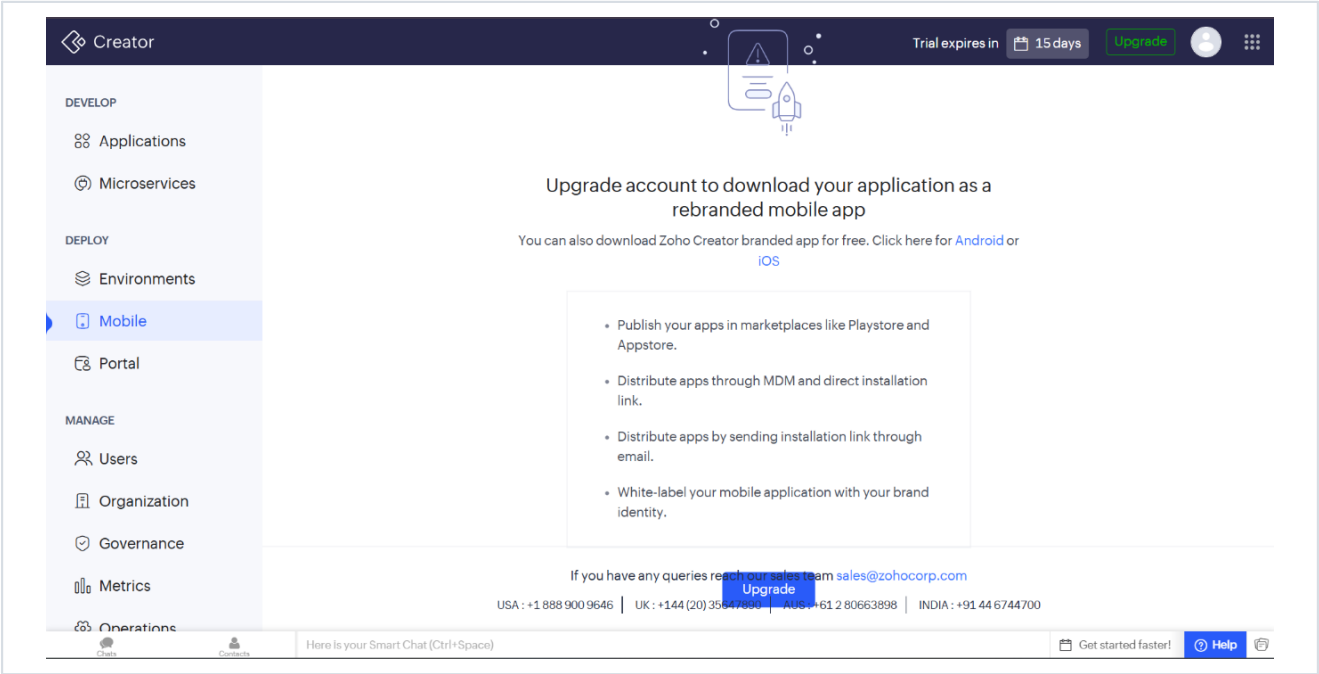
The **Environments** module supports application lifecycle management by providing separate workspaces for Development, Testing, and Production. Developers can safely test new features and modifications before deploying them to live users. This approach minimizes errors, improves software quality, and ensures reliable application deployment.



Environments module interface

04 Mobile

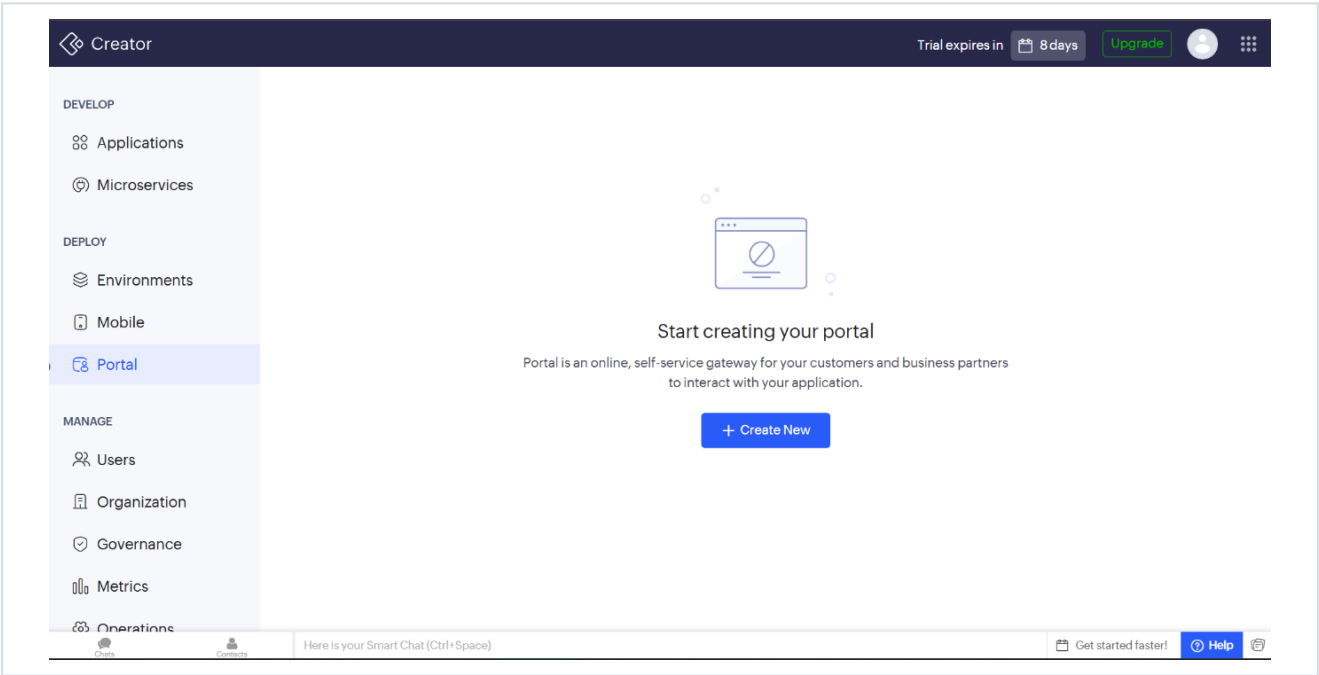
The **Mobile** module allows applications developed in Zoho Creator to be accessed seamlessly on smartphones and tablets. The platform automatically adapts forms, reports, and pages to mobile devices, providing a responsive user experience. This enables users to capture, update, and retrieve business information anytime and from any location.



Mobile module interface

05 Portal

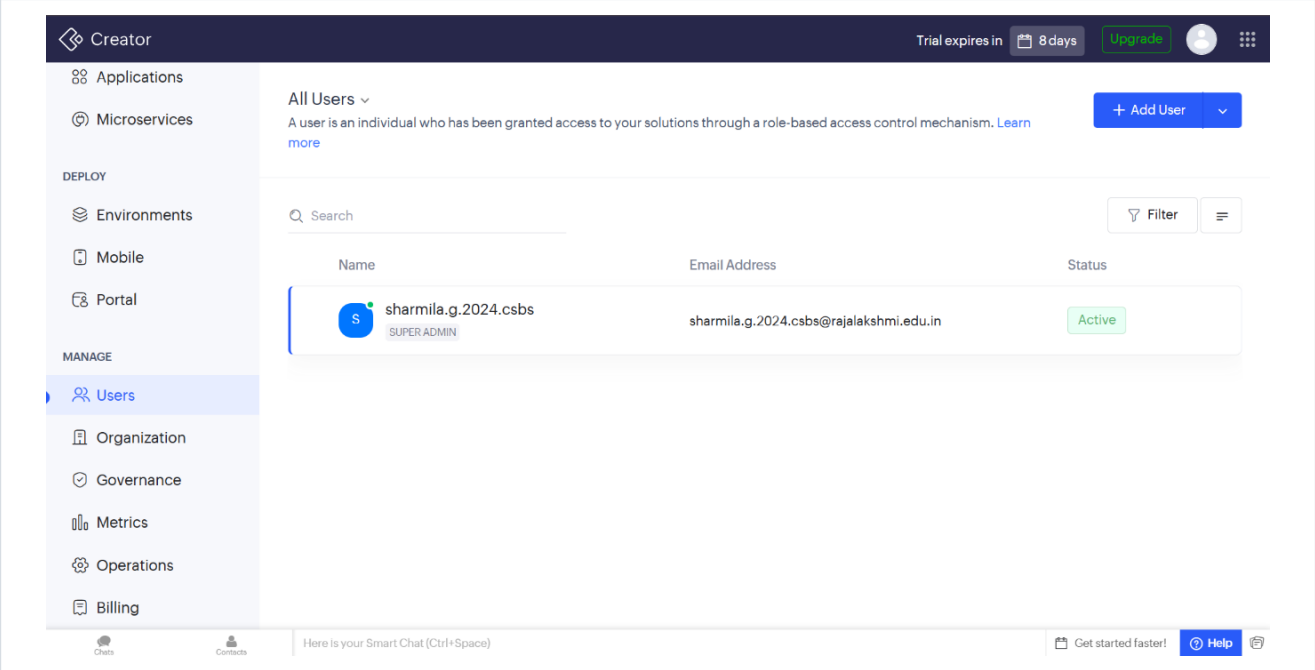
The **Portal** module allows organizations to provide secure access to external users such as customers, vendors, partners, or clients. Portal users can log in using their own credentials to view, submit, or update information based on the permissions assigned to them. This module enhances collaboration while ensuring data security and controlled access.



Portal module interface

06 Users

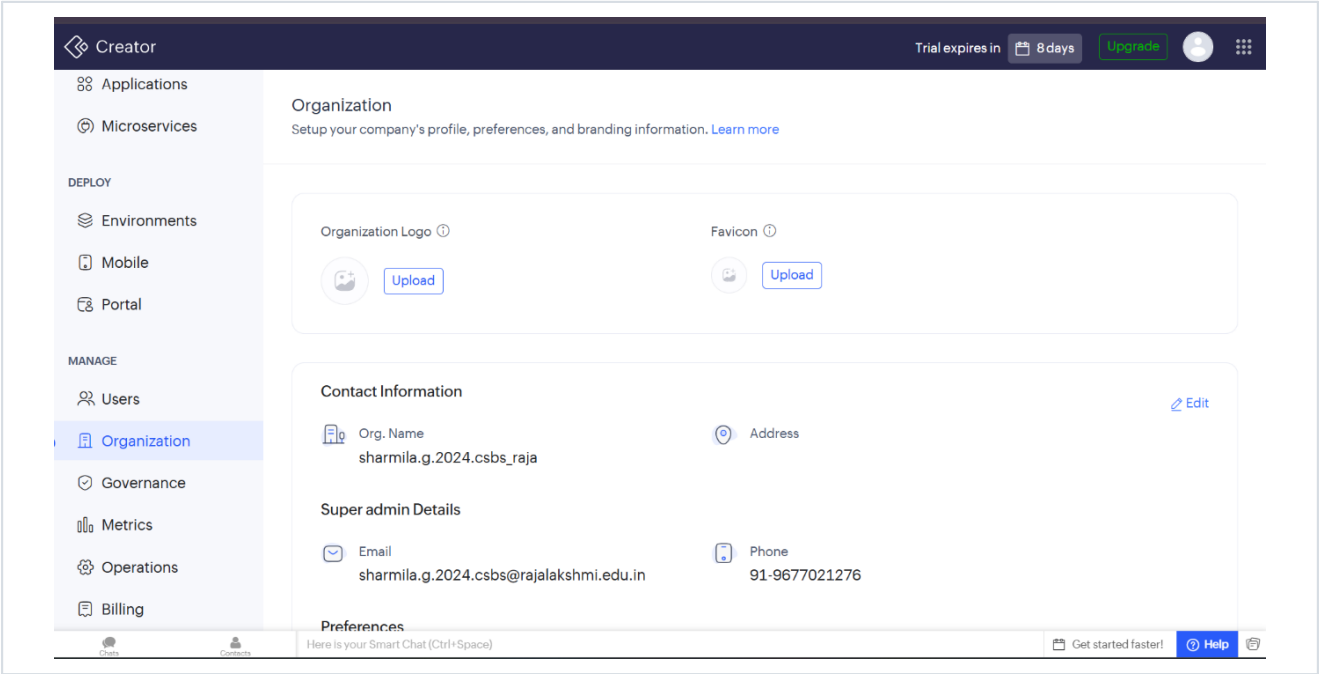
The **Users** module is responsible for managing individuals who have access to Zoho Creator applications. Administrators can add or remove users, assign roles, configure permissions, and control access to different application components. Proper user management ensures secure collaboration and protects sensitive business information.



Users module interface

07 Organization

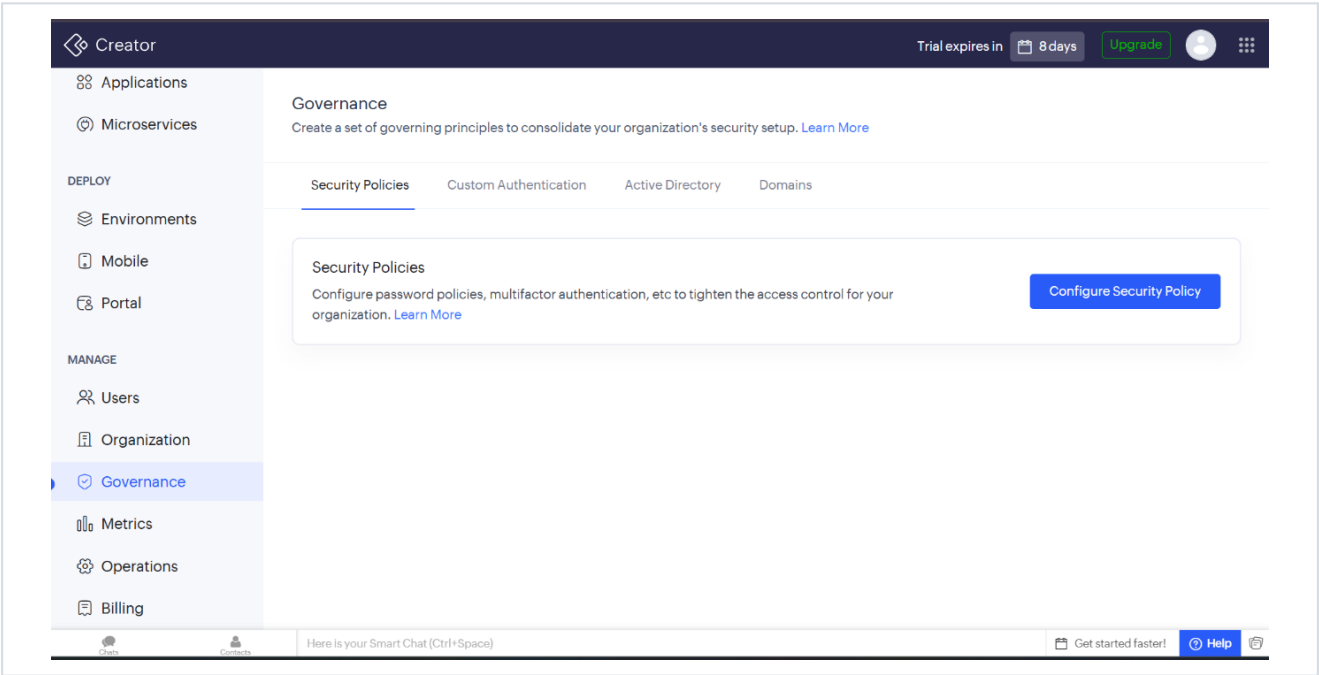
The **Organization** module contains settings related to the overall Zoho Creator account. It allows administrators to manage organizational details, user accounts, licensing, and account preferences. This module helps maintain a structured environment for all applications developed within the organization.



Organization module interface

08 Governance

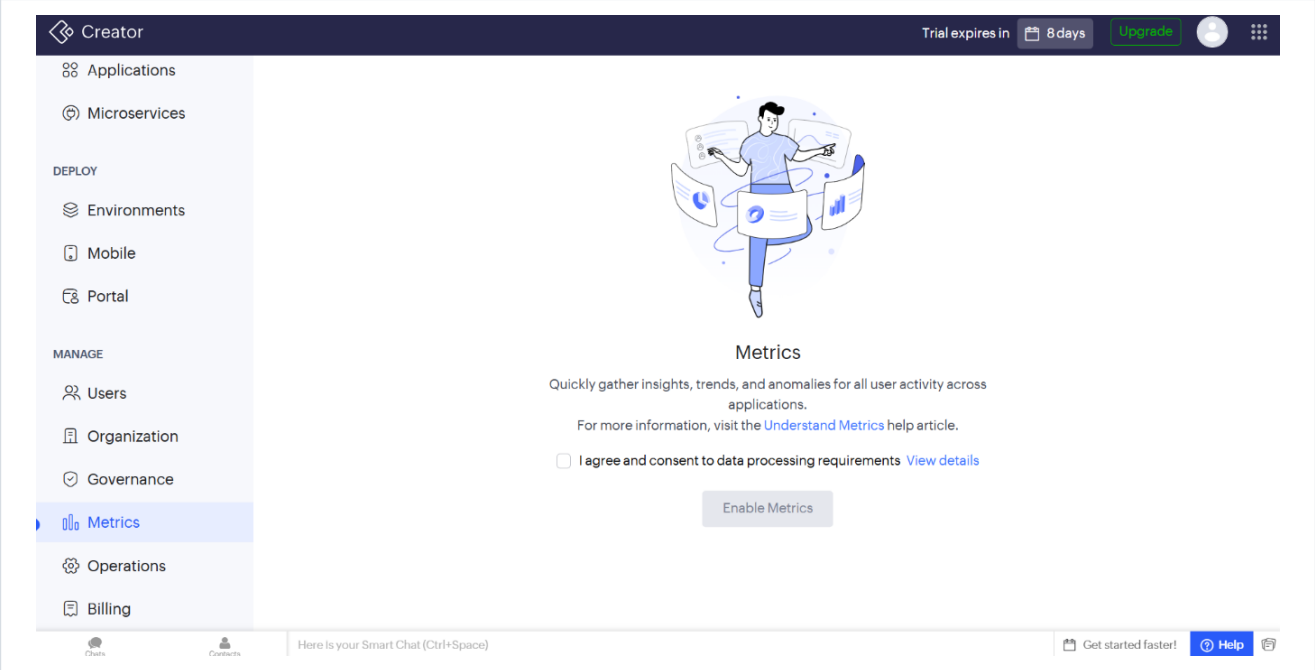
The **Governance** module provides centralized control over application security, compliance, and organizational policies. It helps administrators enforce standards, monitor application usage, manage permissions, and ensure that all applications follow organizational guidelines. This module plays an important role in maintaining secure and well-managed business applications.



Governance module interface

09 Metrics

The **Metrics** module provides detailed insights into the performance and usage of Zoho Creator applications. It displays information such as user activity, storage utilization, application performance, and system statistics through analytical reports. These insights help administrators evaluate application efficiency and make informed decisions for optimization.

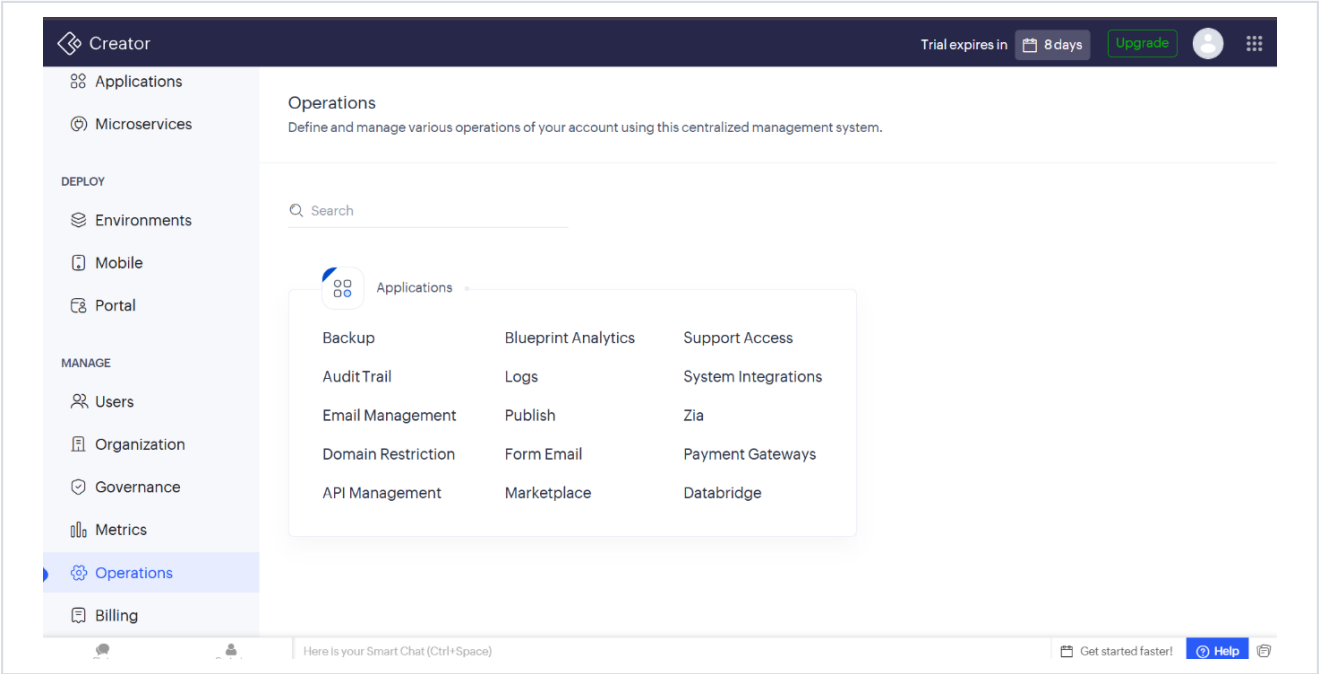


Metrics module interface

10 Operations

The **Operations** module is designed to monitor and manage the operational health of applications. It provides tools for tracking system activities, identifying issues, reviewing logs, and maintaining application performance. This module helps ensure that applications remain stable, reliable, and available for end users.

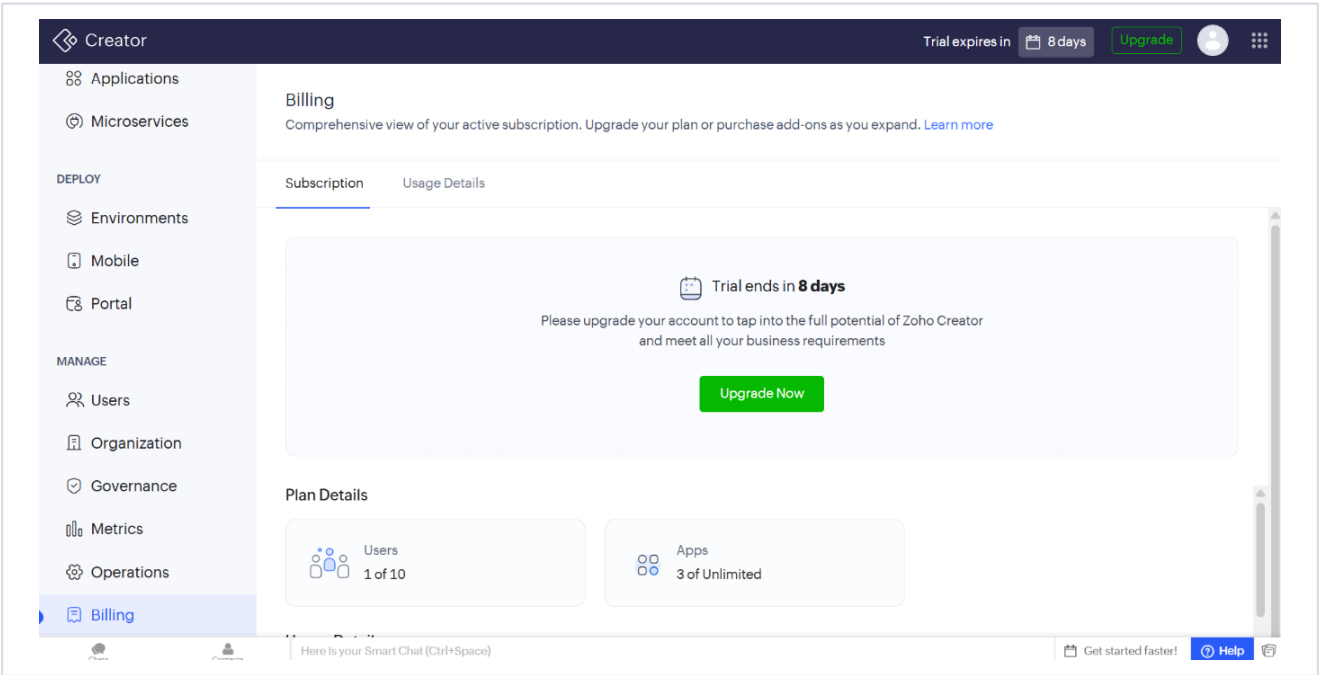
> *These descriptions are record-worthy (around 5–6 lines each), technical, and suitable for a college experiment report. They also match the modules shown in your Zoho Creator interface.*



Operations module interface

11 Billing Module

The **Billing** module in Zoho Creator is used to manage subscription plans, licensing, and payment-related information for the organization. It provides details about the current subscription, billing history, renewal dates, invoices, and payment methods. Administrators can upgrade or downgrade plans, purchase additional user licenses, and monitor account usage based on the selected subscription. This module ensures transparent financial management and helps organizations efficiently track and manage the costs associated with using Zoho Creator.



Billing module interface

Conclusion

This experiment provided a practical understanding of Zoho Creator's application development environment and platform architecture. The platform combines visual development tools with automation capabilities to simplify business application development. Its structured architecture—consisting of Forms, Reports, Pages, Workflows, Deluge scripting, and role-based permissions—supports both non-technical users and professional developers in building scalable and secure applications efficiently.